

The Novalist identity.

Novalist looks like the thing it helps you make: a book. Deep night paper, gilt foil, a serif with a spine. What follows is the working system — colours, type, marks and parts — with the exact values used in the product and on the site.



I · THE MARK ---

Primary — the splash

The full illustration: open book, quill, inkwell, crescent moon. Hero use only, on Ink Night, never below 180px wide. Always a soft gold drop shadow — never a hard edge or container.

Lockup — mark + wordmark

Navigation and footers. The mark is cropped to the book-and-moon (object-position: 50% 38%), 10px from the wordmark. Fraunces 600 — never letterspaced, never all-caps.

Clear space equals the height of the crescent on every side. Do not recolour the mark, place it on light backgrounds, add outlines, or rotate it.

II · PALETTE ---

Ink Night

#0F1219 · --nv-ground

The page. Nothing lighter is ever the ground.

Vellum Panel

#171C2B · --nv-panel

Cards and panels. The only raised surface.

Parchment

#ECE5D2 · --nv-text

Primary text and wordmark. Never pure white.

Faded Ink

#A8A193 · --nv-muted

Body prose, nav links, secondary copy.

Marginalia

#756F62 · --nv-faint

Meta and captions. Never essential reading.

Gilt

#D2A74F · --nv-gold

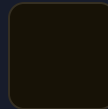
The accent. Eyebrows, rules, fleurons, selection.



Candlelight

#ECC97C · --nv-gold-light

Hover, prose links, card titles, drop caps.



Pressed Ink

#171206 · --nv-on-gold

The only correct label colour on foil.



Gold foil

The one gradient: `linear-`

`gradient(180deg,#ECC97C,#D2A74F)`. Primary buttons and the wordmark plate only. Flat #D2A74F is the sanctioned alternative for print and favicons.

Hairlines & edges

`.055` — nav and section dividers

`.10` — card and panel borders

`.14` — chips and pills

all `rgba(237,230,211, α)` — never

solid grey

shadow: `0 30px 80px -40px rgba(0,0,0,.8)`

III · TYPOGRAPHY

Aa

Fraunces — display

600, tracking `-.01em`.

Headings, wordmark, drop caps, card titles. Never body copy.

Aa

Newsreader — text

400 prose, 500/600 UI labels.

Body 17px/1.7, measure 64–66ch. The default face.

Aa

Courier Prime — record

Anything the machine wrote:

versions, files, sizes, timestamps. 11.5–13px. Never a headline.

Where your whole novel comes together

Hero — Fraunces 600
clamp(38px, 5.6vw, 64px) / 1.08

Your copy of the press.

Section — Fraunces 600
clamp(30px, 3.8vw, 44px) / 1.12

CHAPTER II

Eyebrow — 13px / 600
letter-spacing .34em, Gilt

A codex for your world.

Card title — Fraunces 600
18px, Candlelight

Novalist is an offline-first desktop application for writing novels.

Body — Newsreader 400
17px / 1.7, max 66ch

v1.4.0 · 84.2 MB · free

Record — Courier Prime
11.5-13px, Marginalia

IV · PARTS

Buttons

Download

Coming soon

All releases ↗

Primary: foil, radius 10, Pressed Ink label, hover brightness(1.07). Secondary: hairline outline. Tertiary: plain link with ↗ for anything leaving the site.

Chips & pills

v1.4.0 · 3 days ago

MIT · free

Selected

Facts wear Courier Prime in a hairline pill. Choices wear Newsreader 600 and fill with foil when active. Pills are always 99px — never the card's 18px.

Surfaces

Only two grounds exist: Ink Night and Vellum Panel. Cards use radius 18 and 26–34px padding. Content sits in a 1120px column with 24px gutters; text never exceeds 66ch.

Book marks

- 📖 The fleuron 📖 replaces every bullet in prose.
- 📖 Long passages open with a Fraunces drop cap in Candlelight.
- 📖 Screenshots are Plates — roman numerals, captioned.

Motion is atmospheric only: star twinkle, drifting gold dust, a 5px float. Nothing bounces or slides in on scroll.

V · VOICE

How Novalist speaks

Like a printer, not a startup. Calm, concrete, faintly bookish. It borrows the vocabulary of making books — chapters, plates, editions, revisions, the press — and uses it literally, never as a pun.

Sentences are short and finished. Claims are checkable: what it does, where your files live, what it costs. It never says *revolutionary*, *seamless*, or *unleash*.

In practice

Your copy of the press.

~~Get started for free today!~~

Offline-first — your files, on your disk.

~~Cloud-powered writing, reimagined.~~

chmod +x, then run. No install needed.

~~Effortless one-click installation experience.~~

```
:root {  
  /* ground & surface */  
  --nv-ground:      #0F1219;  
  --nv-panel:       #171C2B;  
  
  /* ink */  
  --nv-text:        #ECE5D2;  
  --nv-muted:       #A8A193;  
  --nv-faint:       #756F62;  
  
  /* gold */  
  --nv-gold:        #D2A74F;  
  --nv-gold-light:  #ECC97C;  
  --nv-on-gold:     #171206;  
  --nv-foil:        linear-gradient(180deg, #ECC97C, #D2A74F);  
  
  /* edges */  
  --nv-line:        rgba(237,230,211,.055);  
  --nv-border:      rgba(237,230,211,.10);  
  --nv-border-firm: rgba(237,230,211,.14);  
  --nv-shadow:      0 30px 80px -40px rgba(0,0,0,.8);  
  
  /* type */  
  --nv-display:     "Fraunces", Georgia, serif;  
  --nv-text-face:   "Newsreader", Georgia, serif;  
  --nv-mono:        "Courier Prime", monospace;  
  
  /* geometry */  
  --nv-radius-card: 18px;  
  --nv-radius-btn:  10px;  
  --nv-radius-pill: 99px;  
  --nv-measure:     1120px;  
  --nv-gutter:      24px;  
}
```

Novalist corporate identity — values taken from the live site and app.